Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
2024 Capital Budget and 2025-2033 Long Range Capital Forecast; and 2024 Operating Budget
Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically at 9:00 a.m. on January 15, 2024

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair – Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 9:02 a.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

Mayor Collier declared a pecuniary interest with respect to part-time aquatics wages and benefits (Item 5.4.1), as he has a family member employed by the Town who works in aquatics.

3. Mayor's Opening Comments

Mayor Collier, Budget Chair, provided opening comments, thanked staff for their hard work on the preparation of the 2024 Operating Budget and 2024 Capital Budget; 2025 **–** 2033 Long Range Capital Forecast, and reviewed highlights of the Mayor's proposed 2024 budget.

4. Capital Budget

4.1 Capital Budget Presentation

Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer delivered a presentation on the 2024 Capital Budget and 2025 **–** 2033 Long Range Capital Forecast.

4.2 Public Comments & Questions

Chair Collier invited comments and questions from the public on the proposed 2024 Capital Budget and 2025 **–** 2033 Long Range Capital Forecast.

Douglas Glass, Ajax resident, addressed Committee Members regarding the 2024 Capital Budget, including impacts on the 2024 estimated property tax bill.

Harvey Brodhecker, Ajax resident, addressed Committee Members regarding the 2024 Capital Budget, including funds allocated to senior services and supports.

Committee recessed at 9:55 a.m.

Committee resumed at 10:03 a.m.

Chris Baker, Ajax resident, address Committee Members regarding the 2024 Capital Budget, including provincial funding opportunities to alleviate the burden on the taxpayer.

Sadique Shaikh, Ajax resident, addressed Committee Members regarding the 2024 Capital Budget, including mechanisms available to deter asylum seekers.

4.3 Discussion and Opportunity for Amendments

Amendment

Moved by: M. Crawford

That $100,000 for traffic calming be added to the Long Range Capital Forecast starting in 2026.

CARRIED

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That Capital Budget item 24001201, the Older Adult Operating Model Analysis be moved from 2025 to 2024.

CARRIED

Committee recessed at 12:04 p.m.

Committee resumed at 12:33 p.m.

5. Operating Budget

5.1 Operating Budget Presentation

D. Valentim delivered a presentation on the 2024 Operating Budget.

5.2 Public Comments & Questions

Chair Collier invited comments and questions from the public on the proposed 2024 Operating Budget.

D. Glass, Ajax resident, addressed Committee Members regarding the 2024 Operating Budget, including recent increases in operating costs.

Chris Baker, Ajax resident, addressed Committee Members regarding the 2024 Operating Budget, including transparency in public communications.

5.3 Discussion & Opportunity for Amendments

Amendment

Moved by: J. Dies

That Council approve the Cultural Coordinator position with a 2024 impact of $67,900.00.

MOTION LOST

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

That the conversion of the part-time Archivist position to full-time in 2024 be removed and the full-time Coordinator of Safety and Operations be added to 2024.

CARRIED

5.4 Council Approval of Items Subject to Mayor Pecuniary Interest

5.4.1 Part-time Aquatics Wages and Benefits

Mayor Collier abstained from voting due to his declared pecuniary interest.

Moved by: S. Lee

That Council approve the budget allocation for part-time aquatics wages in accordance with Section 8(a) of O. Reg 530/22.

CARRIED

6. Adjournment (1:54 p.m.)

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the January 15, 2024 meeting of the General Government Committee Capital Budget and Operating Budget Meeting be adjourned.

CARRIED